

Chapter 6: The Way He Held On

The moment Luna stepped through the door—

Kyros was already there.

But this time...

He didn't just smile.

He walked straight to her.

Fast.

Before she could even say his name—

His hand gently, but firmly, held her wrist.

Pulling her closer.

"Late," he said.

Her eyes widened slightly.

“Excuse me?”

“You’re late,” he repeated, softer now... but his grip didn’t loosen.

Her lips curved.

“Wow... since when did you start keeping time here?”

“Since you became the only thing I wait for.”

Her heart skipped.

“Kyros...”

He exhaled slowly, like he was calming himself down.

“Do you know how long that felt?”

She blinked.

“...It’s been one day.”

“For you.”

The way he said it—

Made it sound like forever.

She looked at his hand still holding her wrist.

“You’re not letting go?”

He glanced down.

Then back at her.

“...Should I?”

She shook her head slightly.

“No.”

That was all he needed.

They started walking—

But he didn’t move far.

Like he didn’t want distance between them anymore.

At one point, Luna slowed down to look at something.

A small glowing flower near the path.

“Kyros, look—”

She turned.

He wasn't looking at the flower.

He was looking at her.

"You're not even seeing it," she said, amused.

"I am."

"No, you're not."

"I am," he insisted softly. "Just not the flower."

Her cheeks warmed slightly.

"Shameless."

"Only with you."

Later, as they walked, someone passed by in the distance—

Just a blur.

But Luna's eyes followed it for a second.

That was enough.

Kyros noticed.

Of course he did.

His fingers tightened slightly around hers.

"Focus," he murmured.

She blinked.

"On what?"

He stepped a little closer.

"Me."

Her breath hitched.

“That sounded... very possessive.”

“...Maybe I am.”

There was no joke in his voice.

And somehow—

She liked it.

“Say it again,” she challenged softly.

He raised an eyebrow.

“What?”

“That.”

He leaned in just a little.

Close enough for his voice to drop.

“Look at me.”

Her heart started racing again.

“I **am** looking at you.”

“Not enough.”

She tried to look away playfully—

But his hand gently moved to her chin.

Turning her face back toward him.

Not rough.

Not forceful.

Just... certain.

“Don’t do that,” he said quietly.

Her voice came out softer.

“Do what?”

“Look away like I don’t matter.”

That line hit deeper than she expected.

“I didn’t mean—”

“I know,” he said, cutting her off gently.

His thumb brushed lightly near her cheek.

“But I still don’t like it.”

Her heart melted a little.

“You’re dangerous,” she whispered.

“Only when it comes to you.”

They sat down later, closer than usual.

This time—

There was no space between them.

Her shoulder pressed against his.

Her hand still in his.

Like it naturally belonged there.

“Kyros...”

“Hm?”

“What if someone tries to take me away from here?”

He didn’t even hesitate.

“They won’t.”

“How do you know?”

His grip tightened slightly.

“Because I won’t let them.”

Her heart fluttered.

“That sounds like a threat.”

“It is.”

She laughed softly.

“You’re not even hiding it anymore.”

“No.”

He turned slightly toward her.

“I don’t want to share you.”

The words were quiet.

But heavy.

Honest.

Her smile faded into something softer.

“Kyros...”

He looked at her.

“I know it sounds—”

She shook her head gently.

“It doesn’t.”

She moved a little closer.

Resting her head against his shoulder again.

“But don’t hold me too tight...”

He stilled.

“Why?”

Her voice softened.

“I might not be able to leave... even when I have to.”

Silence.

A long one.

His fingers slowly intertwined with hers again.

More carefully this time.

“I’ll still hold you,” he said quietly.

“Just enough... so you’ll come back.”

Her eyes closed.

A small smile forming.

“Good answer.”

Time passed like that.

Close.

Quiet.

Full of small touches.

Before leaving—

She stood in front of him.

Closer than ever.

“Say something,” she said softly.

“What do you want to hear?”

She thought for a second.

Then—

“Something only for me.”

He stepped closer.

Very close.

His hand gently pulling her a little nearer.

Until there was almost no space left.

“You’re mine,” he whispered.

Not loud.

Not demanding.

But certain.

Her breath caught.

Her heart racing uncontrollably.

“...Say that again.”

He looked straight into her eyes.

“Only if you mean it too.”

She smiled softly.

Then leaned in slightly.

“...I do.”

That was enough for him.

His forehead rested lightly against hers.

His grip gentle—but still there.

Still holding.

Still choosing her.

“Go,” he whispered finally.

“Before I forget how to let you.”

She stepped back slowly.

Reluctantly.

But smiling.

Because now—

She knew.

He wasn’t just loving her.

He was holding onto her.

In every way he could.